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Portfolio Lab Guide — Chapter 2 (Part I): HTML

Internet Programming, I · Department of Software Engineering · Oct 26, 2026

How this lab works

By the end of these 8 labs, every student has a working two-page personal portfolio (`index.html` + `projects.html`) written in plain HTML. Each lab teaches one group of HTML topics from Chapter 2 (Part I) and adds one feature to the same project, so nothing is thrown away.

Rules for students

- Type every line yourself. Do not copy-paste from this guide; typing is how the tags stick.
- Use **your own** name, photo, skills and courses. The examples use a sample student, *Abebe Kebede*; replace his details with yours.
- Save and refresh the browser after every step. If something looks wrong, check the step's *Common mistakes* box before calling the instructor.
- No CSS yet. The page will look plain. Styling comes in the CSS chapter, where we will style this same portfolio.

Every lab follows the same pattern: Goal → Steps (with code) → Checkpoint (what you should see) → Your turn (a small task without code given) → Common mistakes.

Lab	Portfolio feature you add	Time (min)
0. Setup	Project folder, editor, starter files	15
1. Document structure	Valid HTML5 skeleton for `index.html`	20
2. Headings, paragraphs, ` `, `<hr>`	Page outline: name, About, Skills, Projects, Education, Contact	30
3. Formatting, quotes, code	Rich About Me text, favourite quote, "My first program" snippet	35
4. Hyperlinks	Navigation menu, social links, email/phone, CV download, second page	40
5. Images, image map, favicon	Profile photo, project screenshots, clickable "Connect" banner, tab icon	40
6. Lists	Skills (nested), learning roadmap (ordered), tools glossary (description list)	35
7. Tables	Academic record and projects summary table	45

Total is about 4.5 hours. Suggested split: **Lab session A** = Labs 0–4, **Lab session B** = Labs 5–7 plus submission.

Lab 0 — Setup (15 min)

Goal: a project folder that every later lab writes into.

1. Open **VS Code** (any plain-text editor works; never Word or Notepad with rich text).
2. Optional but recommended: install the **Live Server** extension so the browser refreshes on every save.
3. Create this folder structure on your Desktop. Folder and file names are lowercase with no spaces:

```
portfolio/
├── index.html            ← home page (Labs 1–7)
├── projects.html         ← second page (Lab 4 onward)
├── images/
│   ├── profile.jpg       ← your own photo, about 400×400
│   ├── favicon.png       ← 32×32 tab icon
│   ├── connect-banner.png← 600×200 banner for the image map
│   ├── project-calculator.png
│   └── project-library.png
└── files/
    └── cv.pdf            ← your CV (any PDF for now)
```

4. Copy the files from the instructor's **starter pack** into `images/` and `files/`. Replace `profile.jpg` with your own photo when you can.
5. In VS Code choose **File → Open Folder** and open `portfolio`. Keep the browser and editor side by side for the rest of the lab.

Checkpoint: VS Code's Explorer panel shows the tree above.

Common mistakes: saving as `index.html.txt` (turn on *show file extensions*); spaces or capitals in file names, which break links later on Linux servers.

Lab 1 — Document structure (20 min)

Goal: a valid HTML5 page with your name in the browser tab.

1. Open `index.html` and type the basic HTML skeleton below. Two lines are new: `lang="en"` tells browsers and screen readers the page language, and `<meta charset="UTF-8">` lets you type any character (é, ኣማርኛ) without it turning into symbols.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8">
    <title>Abebe Kebede | Portfolio</title>
</head>
<body>
    <h1>Hello, I am Abebe Kebede</h1>
    <p>This is my portfolio website.</p>
</body>
 /html>
```

2. Save, then open the file in the browser (double-click it, or right-click → *Open with Live Server*).